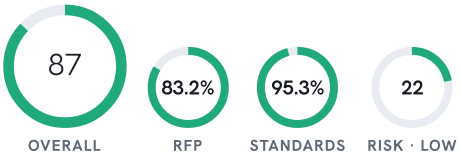
TENDER PRJ-2026-003 · AIR QUALITY AND NOISE MONITORING NETWORK

Sabkha Environmental Systems

Northern Gulf State · Rank 1 of 3 · Report date: 25 October 2026

Preferred bidder



Preferred bidder, subject to conditions: Sabkha offers a sound in-State solution at USD 2,446,848, but several mandatory items are unevidenced and its O&M prices are not fixed.

Executive summary

Sabkha Environmental Systems offers six air-quality stations, four SonoGuard N1 noise terminals, the EnviroDesk platform on the Authority's own servers and three years of operation and maintenance, for a total bid price of USD 2,446,848. The design is sound: the gas analysers use the specified EN principles, data stays in the Authority's data centre with 10-year retention, and alarms are promised within 2 minutes. The main catch is evidence: the EN 16450 certificates are not in the submission, exceedance audio recording is not described, and the UPS gives 1 hour against 2 hours required. The commercial proposal is transparent and reconciles, but O&M for years 2 and 3 escalates by 2.5 % and 70 % of supply payments fall due before acceptance. The Authority should award to Sabkha only once the conditions below close the mandatory gaps and fix the O&M price.

Technical proposal

Adequate

The solution is well chosen: the PM and gas analysers come from one manufacturer whose range Sabkha represents in the State, stations hold 30 days of local data on dual-SIM 4G, and the platform is hosted as the RFP requires. The weakness is evidence rather than design. The EN 16450 certificates, the certifier's accreditation, the exceedance audio recording and the mapping of stations to AQ-1 to AQ-6 and N-1 to N-4 are missing or unstated, and Annex A marks several clauses 'Comply' where the text says otherwise. The O&M scope covers calibration, consumables, repairs and noise verification but does not say when the 3-year term starts. Three references each have at least four stations, but no client contacts are given.

STRENGTHS

- ✓ Gas analysers match the specified principles: NO2 by chemiluminescence (EN 14211), SO2 by UV fluorescence (EN 14212) and O3 by UV photometry (EN 14625), all stated as type-approved.
  REQ-006 · EM-02 · Technical proposal p. 2
- ✓ The platform and all monitoring data sit on two virtual servers in the Authority's data centre, with 10-year retention of raw and validated data and no data leaving the Authority's infrastructure.
  REQ-011 · REQ-012 · Technical proposal pp. 2–3
- ✓ Limit-value alarms reach the HSE duty officer by SMS and e-mail within 2 minutes, against the 5 minutes required, and validation keeps a full audit trail. REQ-013 · REQ-014 · Technical proposal p. 2

WEAKNESSES

- ✗ EN 16450 certificates (Appendix B) are not in the technical proposal, and TÜV's accreditation as certifier is not stated; this mandatory requirement is unverified, yet Annex A says 'Comply'.
  REQ-005 · EM-01 · Technical proposal p. 2; Annex A p. 4
- ✗ No audio recording of exceedances is described; the terminals store LAeq values and 1/3-octave spectra only. The clause is mandatory and Annex A says 'Comply'. REQ-007 · Technical proposal p. 2; Annex A p. 4
- ✗ Each station's UPS runs for 1 hour against at least 2 hours required, and Annex A pairs 'UPS 1 h' with 'Comply' against 'UPS ≥ 2 h'.
  REQ-008 · Technical proposal pp. 2, 4
- ✗ Stations and terminals are not mapped to AQ-1 to AQ-6 or N-1 to N-4, and the three references have no client contacts.
  REQ-001 · REQ-002 · REQ-024 · Technical proposal p. 2

Commercial proposal

Adequate

The price is transparent: six stations at USD 212,000 each, four terminals at USD 18,500 each, a platform licence, servers, installation, training and O&M, with line items that reconcile to USD 1,721,000 for supply and installation and USD 725,848 for O&M. Against the other bids, the total is above Kaltenmoor Messtechnik's USD 2,174,200 but not out of line with it, while Nimbrel Sensing's USD 552,600 is too far below both to serve as a benchmark without checking its scope. The 120-day validity, the 10 % advance within the 20 % limit and the warranty included in the supply prices are acceptable. The O&M deviation and the payment structure, however, favour the vendor.

STRENGTHS

- ✓ Supply and installation (USD 1,721,000) is shown separately from 3-year O&M (USD 725,848), so the evaluated price can be applied as RFP §8.2 requires. REQ-028 · Commercial proposal p. 1
- ✓ The 10 % advance is within the 20 % limit and covered by an advance-payment guarantee; the 24-month warranty is included in the supply prices; bid validity is 120 days.
  REQ-029 · REQ-021 · REQ-031 · Commercial proposal pp. 1–2
- ✓ Performance security is offered at 10 % of the contract price, as RFP §7.3 requires. REQ-030 · Commercial proposal p. 2

WEAKNESSES

- ✗ O&M for years 2 and 3 escalates by 2.5 % a year (USD 241,900 and USD 247,948), a deviation from the fixed-price requirement that adds USD 17,848 over a fixed year-1 price.
  REQ-027 · Commercial proposal pp. 1–2
- ✗ 70 % of supply payments fall due before acceptance (10 % advance, 60 % on delivery of the stations to site), and O&M is invoiced quarterly in arrears rather than against milestones.
  REQ-029 · Commercial proposal p. 2
- ✗ Bid security and performance security are from Al-Noor National Bank, whose State licence is not stated, and the USD 25,000 bid guarantee is not in the submission.
  REQ-030 · REQ-032 · Commercial proposal p. 2

Technical vs commercial balance

Technical proposal: Adequate | Commercial proposal: Adequate

The technical proposal carries the bid: its design fits the specification and the vendor has the local presence to deliver it, but its mandatory gaps are technical. The commercial proposal is clear and reconciles, but the escalation and front-loaded payments mean the Authority will pay more, and have less leverage, than the evaluated price suggests. Commercial terms should not be negotiated until the technical evidence is complete.

Value for money: For USD 2,446,848 the Authority gets a complete network, a 10-year data record on its own servers and three years of maintenance, at a price that is plausible against the other bids. That value holds only if the missing evidence is supplied and the O&M price is fixed.

Key concerns for the client

1. **Mandatory items unproven.** The EN 16450 certificates, exceedance audio recording and bank licences are mandatory and unevidenced. If they prove missing after award, permit data may not be accepted by the Environment Agency, and the resulting dispute over replacement would be costly.
2. **Compliance matrix overstates delivery.** Annex A marks clauses 3.3 and 3.4 as 'Comply' against contrary details. If the contract follows the matrix headings rather than the technical text, the Authority will face change requests at the vendor's price.
3. **No schedule float and unpriced software.** Acceptance at month 6 leaves no slack after commissioning in months 4–5 and the 30-day trial, while 60 % is paid on delivery. The perpetual EnviroDesk licence has no priced support or upgrades beyond the 3-year O&M term.

Consultant's recommendation

The design is sound and the price is transparent, so Sabkha Environmental Systems should be preferred for award. The award should be conditional, however: several mandatory requirements are claimed but not evidenced, and the O&M escalation must be removed. The Authority should not treat these gaps as a post-award fix; if they cannot be closed before contract signature, the committee should reconsider the award.

CONDITIONS BEFORE AWARD

1. Establish whether the Appendix B EN 16450 certificates were in the sealed envelope; if not, decide under the tender rules whether they may be supplied, and in any case obtain certificates from an accredited body for each PM model before signature.
2. Obtain written confirmation and a datasheet that the SonoGuard N1 records audio of exceedances, with an acceptance test for it.
3. Provide the USD 25,000 bid security and the 10 % performance security from banks licensed in the State, with the licence stated.
4. Confirm a UPS of at least 2 hours at each station and a corrected, itemised Annex A matrix.
5. Provide a site layout with coordinates mapping the stations to AQ-1 to AQ-6 and the terminals to N-1 to N-4.

NEGOTIATION POINTS

1. Fix O&M at USD 236,000 a year for three years, removing the 2.5 % escalation.
2. Reduce the 60 % payment on delivery and tie payments to installation, commissioning and the trial run, with O&M invoices tied to calibration and data-capture records.
3. Price EnviroDesk software support and upgrades beyond year 3 as a fixed option, and make the 24-hour response a contractual service level.

CLARIFICATIONS TO REQUEST

1. Client contacts (name, role, telephone, e-mail) for the Ras Hadd, Al-Waha and Eastern Province Ports references.
2. The location of the disaster-recovery site, confirmation that it is in the State, and the name of the private APN carrier.
3. The start date of the 3-year O&M term, and whether it runs from acceptance as RFP §2.4 requires.

Prepared by Mizan with Claude Haiku 5.5, acting as a procurement consultant, from the RFP, the vendor's proposal and Mizan's evaluation. Scores are computed by Mizan's scoring rules. AI-generated: verify key facts against the source documents before deciding.